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DREAM MACHINE | Creative AI News & Insight { July 2026 - Issue 37 }

**Pete Woodbridge** ✓Innovation Leader | AI & Emerging Tech | Creative Tech | R&D
| Software Engineer

July 9, 2026

Welcome to edition 37 of Dream Machine. Covering **AI in the Creative Industries**: Film, Music, Games....

Created and curated by [DreamLab](#), a collective of artists, creative technologists, directors, games & software developers..... including Emmy winners, PhD researchers, and BAFTA recognised talent.

You can also listen to the [Dream Machine Podcast](#) 🎧 and for deeper insights and full on analysis, along with some predictions and advice about where this is all going... check out the [Dream Machine: Artificial Intelligence and the Next Creative Economy](#) Book, now updated to the 3rd edition.



Dream Machine #41: Disney's J.A.R.V.I.S., AI's Generational Divide

Preview Aug 11 • Dream Machine - Creative AI

**Editor's Pick: The Rise of the Creative HI-C: When One
Person Gets an AI Army**

The Institute for the Future recently introduced the idea of the **High-Impact Individual Contributor (HI-C)**—someone who can achieve the output of much larger teams by combining deep expertise with powerful AI systems.

In the creative industries, the implications are profound. AI is giving individuals capabilities that once required entire departments. A filmmaker can develop concepts, generate storyboards, create visual effects, edit footage and build marketing assets from a single workstation. A musician can compose, produce, master and promote a release from a laptop. A small game team can prototype worlds, characters and gameplay in weeks rather than months.

The creative economy is shifting from **economies of scale to economies of capability**. Increasingly, competitive advantage won't come from employing the biggest teams, but from combining human creativity with an increasingly capable AI stack.

But capability isn't the same as creativity, the craft always matters. The assumption behind the HI-C is that if one person can now do the work of many, then perhaps they no longer need the many. Yet some of the best creative work has never emerged from production alone—it emerges from **creative friction**.

Scripts improve because producers challenge writers. Films change in the edit. Games become fun because playtesters expose what isn't working. Albums evolve through collaboration, disagreement and experimentation. Almost no great creative work ends exactly as it was first imagined. It is shaped by hundreds of conversations, critiques, taste judgements and unexpected discoveries along the way.

That's what creative expertise often buys you. Not simply the ability to produce work, but the ability to question it- and processes that deliberately create conditions for human critique, collaboration and taste where it matters most. AI can generate endless variations, suggest improvements and accelerate production, but it cannot fully replace the diversity of perspectives and lived experience that refine ideas into exceptional work. It can tell you what is possible; it is far less reliable at knowing what is meaningful.

So perhaps the real future isn't the one-person studio after all. It's the AI-enabled creative team—smaller, faster and far more capable than before, but built around human ability to craft, judge, criticise and collaborate. The HI-C is real. Individuals will achieve more than ever before in this era, and a generation will grow up natively with these tools in their palette. Teams will likely become leaner in some ways, but bigger in others. Production may become dramatically more efficient. But as we reduce the distance between idea and execution, one question becomes increasingly important: **If creativity loses its friction, what else might it lose?**



Video, Film, TV & Animation

- BBC World Service's Witness History to launch first AI-animated video episodes [LINK](#)
- Into the spider's lair: how an Australian film-maker made an impossible documentary with AI [LINK](#)
- Midjourney wants Hollywood studios (ie Disney, Universal, Warner Bros) to reveal the details of their AI usage [LINK](#)
- Martin Sorrell: Cannes is obsessing over the wrong AI debate, because we are firmly in the AI Era Now [LINK](#)
- ABC trials AI writing tools for news staff amid trust warnings [LINK](#)
- ByteDance Is Pitching Its AI Video Tool To Hollywood [LINK](#)
- AI 'Actor' Tilly Norwood To Star In Feature Film 'Misaligned' [LINK](#)
- Kling AI Raises Record \$2.8 Billion: What Creators Owe China Under Beijing Law [LINK](#)
- How Hollywood's youngest filmmakers are exposing Gen Z's real problem with AI [LINK](#)
- Walt Disney Imagineering R&D will use Adobe Firefly Foundry to build custom AI models responsibly trained on our own, licensed creative catalog [LINK](#)

Games, Immersive & Interactive

- Sony leadership says AI tools are "an important foundational technology supporting our strategy" [LINK](#)
- Tripo AI raises \$150M for GenAI tools for gaming — a month after its previous \$200M raise [LINK](#)
- Epic Games' CEO argues AI could've made Destiny profitable [LINK](#)
- Cambridge's Worldmodeldata raises £7M to turn video games into AI training data [LINK](#)
- My 11-year-old son used AI to build his own video game — I see it as a creativity boost, not a threat [LINK](#)
- Microsoft cut around 4,800 roles, or 2.1% of its global workforce, on Monday — the latest in a series of layoffs that's stoking fears that AI will replace people at companies. [LINK](#)
- ElevenLabs is working on a Unity SDK so you can add real-time voice agents to your games [LINK](#)

Music & Sound

- Suno explores developer API, seeking apps 'that unlock experiences generative music makes possible for the first time' [LINK](#)
- Suno Spark - A Development programme for music artists Igniting the next generation of independent artists. [LINK](#)
- An Atlantic investigation just blew open the AI music industry's data provenance problem- revealing the datasets that may have trained ai platforms [LINK](#)
- The BBC's Policy on the use of AI in Music [LINK](#)
- AI-powered live-music firm Gotobeat expands to arena shows [LINK](#)
- 'AI-native' Indian ticketing platform thumpN aims to put 'discovery first' [LINK](#)
- The Music Industry Has an Engineering Problem [LINK](#)
- "I'm very excited by AI if the person using it is also creative and not just lazy": We catch up with Swedish house legend John Dahlbäck [LINK](#)

- Want to know how the major labels see AI? Check their financial filings... [LINK](#)
- AI Music Generators Are Changing the Game for Independent Content Creators [LINK](#)
- AI-powered platform Eros Music Worlds is turning film characters into virtual singers [LINK](#)
- Musixmatch reveals winners of its first AI-focused hackathon [LINK](#)
- Suno Quickly Seizes on Udio's Legal Victory Against Sony Music Over Admissible Infringed Works [LINK](#)
- Australian Agency Apologizes After Booking an AI Artist [LINK](#)

More Creative & AI News

- Analysis of 1.4 million AI interactions identifies the employee behaviors behind effective AI use—and how they can be taught at scale [LINK](#)
- Army of one: the rise of the High Impact Individual Contributor, "an individual contributor who can complete a project that delivers business value, end-to-end, on their own." [LINK](#)
- What if AI's first labor-market effect isn't replacing workers, but making traditional firms less necessary? How AI is accelerating the shift toward independent work. [LINK](#)
- Our interest in AI slop is hitting a ceiling [LINK](#)
- Access to Claude Fable 5 and Mythos 5 is now restored, here's how it is being redeployed [LINK](#)
- TikTok Turns Ad Workflows Into An AI Skills Marketplace [LINK](#)
- Arts Council England launches Responsible AI Cultural Leaders Academy [LINK](#)

Tools

Tool Drops and Tutorials

- Gracia AI - 4D Gaussian splatting in Unreal Engine; lighting and more, Real-time lighting (splat relighting) and shadows, including self-shadowing• Drag-and-drop 4DGS import with synchronized playback and transitions [LINK](#)
- Seedream 5.0 Pro is out. ByteDance's latest image model with Character & product consistency across edits, Precision region editing, infographics, flowcharts & structured layouts, In-image text across 14 languages. [LINK](#)
- Unreal Engine to 4D Gaussian Splat is here! Available now in Atlux, and for UE 5.8 as well [LINK](#)

Notch Tutorial: Gaussian Splats

Notch



Watch on

- Notch 2026.2 Adds Native Gaussian Splat Import and Rendering [LINK](#)

GPT Live from Open AI

- GPT-Live from OpenAI, a new generation of voice models for natural human-AI interaction [LINK](#)
- A new render-to-real IC-LoRA for LTX-2.3 from fal lets you turn any 3D / CG / game render into high quality 3d render, photorealistic, film-quality video, keeping your exact composition and camera move using the first frame. [LINK](#)
- Moverse Capture Studio v1.3.5: **Automatic actor tracking** is here [LINK](#)
- You can now train a 3D LoRA, exclusively on fal [LINK](#)
- Ludo AI updates Sprite Generator with new animation and export tools [LINK](#)

Neural Render Proxies for Interactive and Differentia

DisneyResearchHub



Watch on

- Disney's New Research on Neural Render Proxies for Interactive and Differentiable Lighting [LINK](#)
- "Music to Dance," a feature that generates dance videos from music, has been added to Wan Video. [LINK](#)
- Reactor has announced Lingbot-World-2, its new real-time world generation model. [LINK](#)
- Meta has a new app to let you make little AI experiences [LINK](#)
- Need gaming datasets? checkout this open source library of over 500 hours of gaming data [LINK](#)

Autoremesher

- AutoRemesher is a cross-platform automatic quad remeshing tool that converts high-polygon meshes into clean quad-based topology. [LINK](#)
- TriFlow: Generating Artist-Like 3D Mesh Topology via Nearest-Vertex Vector Fields [LINK](#)
- Introducing Rodin Gen-2.5 (0702) - Better Geometry on High Tier, 8K textures available for all users, Dreamy emissive Bloom textures [LINK](#)
- For the researchers here: PaperBanana: Automating Academic Illustration for AI Scientists [LINK](#)
- LTX2.3 LoRA Seamless-Equirectangular [LINK](#)
- AlayaWorld: Long-Horizon and Playable Video World Generation [LINK](#)
- Meta launches Muse Image AI generator [LINK](#)
- Video Remix in Google Photos. Swap backgrounds, fix lighting, or add artistic effects like watercolor and oil painting. [LINK](#)

Pika Directors Suite

- Pika Director's Suite, an experimental video creation product, is finally open for invite-only access. [LINK](#)

Next Time...

If you've got any recommendations, opportunities or news we need to know about for our next edition please feel free to reach out.



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